

Samson Occom, narrative, 1765 November 28

The Occom Circle



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Author [Occom, Samson](#)

Date 28 November, 1765

Abstract Occom writes a brief account of his life and education.

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Since there is great misrepresentations by Some Concerning my Life and Education; I take this opportunity to give the World in few words, the true account of my Education — I was Born a Heathen in Mmoyanheeunnuck alias [Mohegan](#) in [New London](#). [North America](#), my Parents were altogether Heathens, and I was Educated by them in their heathenish Notions, though there was a Sermon preached to our [Mohegan Tribe](#) sometimes, but our Indians regarded not the Christian Religion, they would persist in their heathenish ways, and my Parents in particular were very Strong in the customs of their forefathers, and they had a wandering Life up and down in the wilderness, for my Father was a great Hunter, thus I lived with them, 'til I was Sixteen years old, and then there was a great Stir of Religion in these Parts of the World both amongst the Indians as well as the English, and about this Time I began to think about the Christian Religion, and was under great trouble of Mind for Some Time, I thought the Religion which I heard at this Time was a new thing among mankind, Such as they never heard the like before, So Ignorant was I — and when I was Seventeen years of Age I received a Hope, and as I began to think about Religion So I began to learn to read, though I went to no School, 'til I was in my nineteenth year, and then I went to the Rev. [Mr. Wheelocks](#) to learn, and Spent four years there, and was very weakly most of the Time; this is the true account of my Education,

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